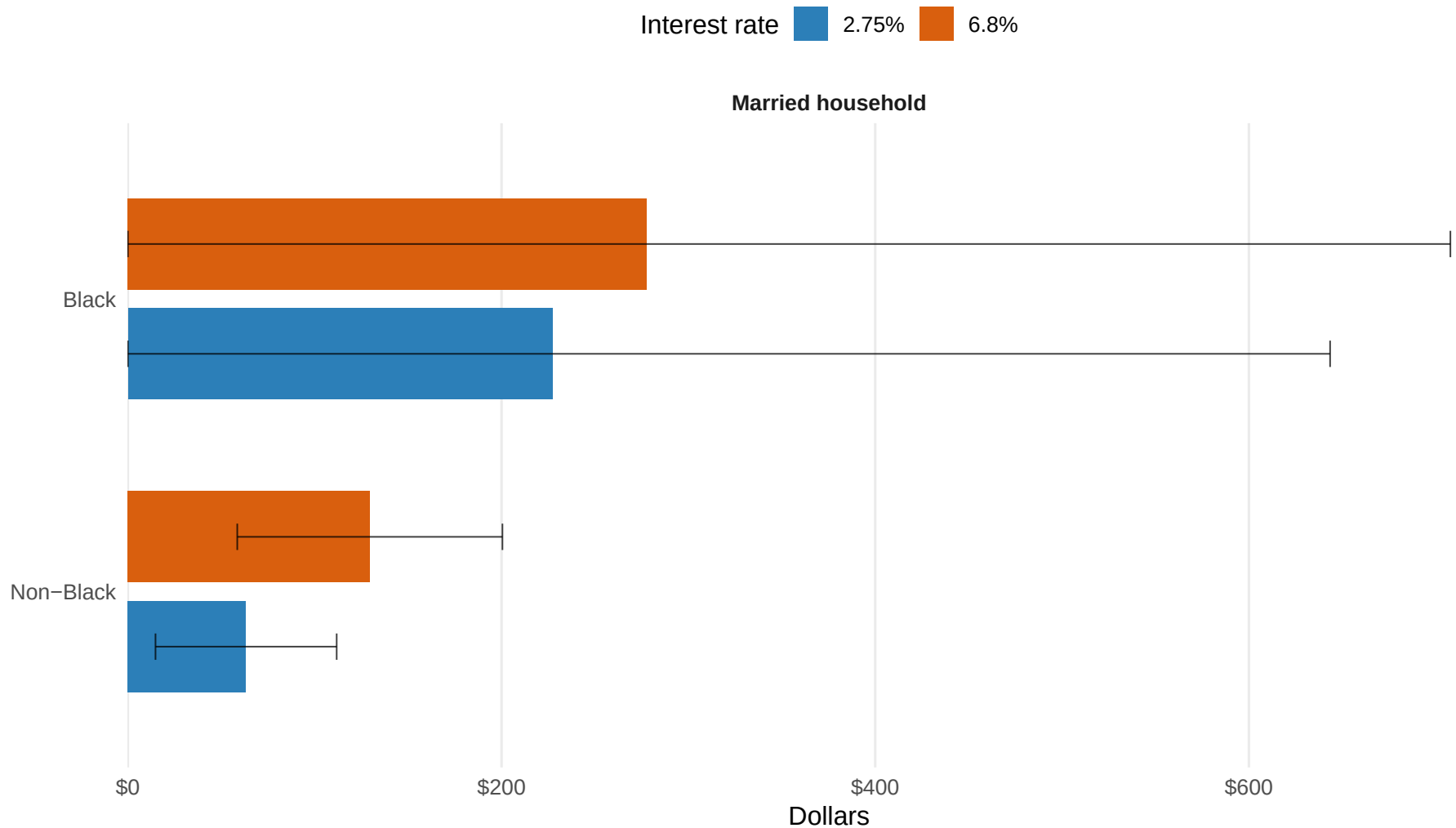


Figure 2: A Higher Married Cap Expands Deductions Most for Some Groups

Estimated allowable-deduction gain from raising the married-household deduction cap to \$5,000 for Black and Non-Black households.



Author's analysis of 2024 Survey of Income and Program Participation data. Population: subgroup means among eligible households with positive student debt; unmarried households have zero modeled gain by design because their cap is unchanged. Tax savings equal allowable deduction times an estimated 2025 federal marginal tax rate. The 2.75% and 6.8% rates are the minimum and maximum undergraduate federal loan rates from 2000 through 2025; because borrower-specific loan terms are not observed, they show a plausible range of impacts. Error bars show 95% confidence intervals.